Who Shapes the Artificial Intelligence Act?

2,021/0106(COD): 3,003 amendments, 737 disclosed lobbying meetings, and 532 organisations across 9 policy themes

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The Lobbying Landscape

The AI Act attracted 532 distinct organisations across 737 disclosed EP lobbying meetings and 231 Commission meetings, 102 of which included substantive notes. Google leads all organisations by meeting count (37 disclosed contacts), followed by Microsoft (26), OpenAI (20), the American Chamber of Commerce to the European Union (15), and Meta Platforms (13). Among organisations that explicitly do not represent commercial interests, European Digital Rights (10), BEUC (7), The Future Society (7), and the Future of Life Institute (7) are the most active.

Among the thirty most active organisations by disclosed meetings, those representing commercial interests account for approximately 198 meetings, compared to 42 for explicitly non-commercial organisations – a ratio of roughly 5:1. This figure covers disclosed meetings only; informal contacts are unobservable and may be substantial.

Commission lobbying concentrated most heavily on innovation and SME support (31 meetings involving 29 distinct organisations), human oversight and fundamental rights (21), and transparency and explainability (15). The organisations lobbying on innovation framing were predominantly commercial, though a handful of civil society bodies – including BEUC and Access Now Europe – were active on oversight and rights themes.

The Statistical Finding

A Fisher's exact test on n=18 MEPs tested whether MEPs in the high-exposure group (above the median Lobby Exposure Index) were more likely to fall in the high thematic-overlap group. The result is statistically significant (odds ratio = 63.0, p = 0.0029): higher-exposure MEPs are strongly associated with broader thematic overlap with lobbying activity. This finding is consistent with two interpretations – that exposure shapes amendment scope, or that lobbyists direct effort toward MEPs already active on relevant themes – and the data cannot distinguish between them. A separate Pearson correlation between LEI and total amendment count is also statistically significant (r = 0.57, p = 0.014, n = 18), suggesting that more exposed MEPs tend to table more amendments overall. No statistically significant relationship was found between ALAS and amendments on commercial themes (r = 0.35, p = 0.16).

Directional Alignment

Among the nine MEPs for whom directional alignment could be evaluated, alignment fractions vary meaningfully. Eva Maydell (EPP, Opinion Rapporteur) shows the highest fraction: 62 of 100 evaluated amendment-position pairs move in the same direction as disclosed lobby positions, an alignment fraction of 0.62. Deirdre Clune (EPP, Shadow) follows at 51 of 115 pairs (0.44), and

Petar Vitanov (S&D, Shadow) at 52 of 125 (0.42). In each case, amendments move toward lobby positions more often than away, though a substantial share of pairs are scored as neutral.

Axel Voss (EPP, Opinion Rapporteur) presents a different profile. He recorded the highest disclosed meeting count of any MEP in the dataset (102 meetings) and the highest LEI (0.0286), yet his alignment fraction – 44 of 125 pairs (0.35) – is among the lower values in the group. Brando Benifei (S&D, Shadow) and Dragoş Tudorache (Renew, Shadow), both among the most active MEPs by meetings (111 and 125 respectively), sit at 52 of 165 pairs (0.32) and 47 of 150 pairs (0.31). In all three cases, amendments move toward lobby positions more often than away, but the margin is smaller than for Maydell or Clune.

Nine MEPs recorded zero evaluable pairs, either because their disclosed meeting count was zero – Cornelia Ernst, Jean-Lin Lacapelle, Jaak Madison, Josianne Cutajar, and Susana Solís Pérez – or because no actionable directional positions could be extracted from available meeting records.

Theme-Level Observations

Conformity assessment and enforcement generated the most amendments of any theme (1,043), yet attracted only a single Commission lobbying meeting in the dataset. This gap – high parliamentary activity alongside near-absent observable Commission lobbying contact – suggests that enforcement architecture was shaped primarily in the parliamentary arena rather than through formal Commission-level engagement. The same divergence appears for prohibited AI practices, which produced 432 amendments against zero Commission meetings.

The reverse pattern holds for innovation and SME support: it attracted more Commission lobbying contacts than any other theme (31 meetings), yet produced only 185 amendments – the second lowest count across all themes. This is consistent with industry-oriented lobbying directed toward the Commission's delegated-act and implementation mechanisms rather than toward the parliamentary text itself.

Human oversight and fundamental rights shows a more balanced profile: 21 Commission meetings and 389 amendments, with a diverse lobbying pool of 16 active organisations spanning commercial technology firms and civil liberties bodies alike.

Limitations

This analysis is based entirely on meetings disclosed in the EU Transparency Register and parliamentary records; informal contacts, written submissions, and communications outside the register are unobservable and may be substantial. Temporal ordering between meetings and amendments was not verified, meaning some lobbying contacts may postdate the amendments with which they are compared – a constraint that limits any directional inference. All statistical findings are associational and cannot establish causation.

This briefing was produced by an automated analysis pipeline using publicly disclosed EU institutional data and does not establish causal relationships between lobbying activity and legislative outcomes.